

In today's digital world, news has become a fleeting commodity. We are immersed in a flood of information, with countless headlines passing by like fleeting clouds; we click, browse, and then forget them within a few seconds. This culture has led to the extreme devaluation of information and the fragmentation of attention.

This project aims to critique and visualize this phenomenon through web interaction design.

In this project, the user controls a character running across constantly generating and collapsing blocks of news.

Each platform stepped by the character displays a news item. It can only support the character's weight for a brief moment. Once the character leaves, the platform immediately falls and is destroyed. This symbolizes the fate of modern news—they are disposable stepping stones consumed and then discarded.

Project Description:

This is a web-based interactive news reading application that reimagines traditional list-based news aggregators into a 2D side-scrolling interface. The project utilizes a physics engine and dynamic DOM manipulation to create a generative environment driven by real-time news data. Users control a character named "Reader" using WASD and the spacebar to run and jump between platforms. Each "platform" in the interface corresponds to a piece of real-time news data fetched from an external API. Users navigate between these floating news blocks by jumping and running to browse the information stream.

- Foreground contains the game character and physical platforms, which remain highlighted and dynamic. When the character touches and stays on a news platform, the detailed information of that news item (including large title, summary, publication time, and source) will be rendered to the bottom layer of the webpage.
- When the character leaves the current news platform and jumps to the next, the old platform will fall and disappear from the screen.
- The webpage has no endpoint. The map generation algorithm infinitely builds the terrain ahead based on the streaming news data input.
- The algorithm automatically calculates the physical width of the platform based on the length of the news titles.

- The height difference and spacing of the platforms are randomly generated but constrained within the character's maximum jump range to ensure a smooth experience.
- The application's visual style will adopt a minimalist design, using high-contrast typography to ensure that the background text remains clearly readable behind the game elements. The system will dynamically adjust the main background color based on the news category providing intuitive visual classification.

Design and Interaction Concepts

- Platforms that have been stepped on (news articles that have been read) will physically drop off the bottom of the screen. This forces users to only look forward, simulating the irreversibility of time passing and information being forgotten.
- When a user hovers over a trending news item, the detailed content of that news item will occupy the entire webpage background. Although the news occupies your field of vision, it is only the background, not the ultimate destination.

Target Audience:

- A generation accustomed to the infinite scroll mechanism of social media, but who are beginning to feel anxious and empty due to information overload.
- Interaction designers, digital artists, and users interested in media theory.

Technology Stack:

- **HTML5/CSS3 & ES6+:** For building the basic structure.
- **Matter.js (Physics Engine):** To simulate weightlessness and falling.
- **NewsAPI / JSON Mock:** To fetch real-time data streams.
- **Hosting:** GitHub Pages.

Risks:

Risk 1: Ambiguity in Concept Communication

- Challenge: Users might perceive it simply as a rudimentary parkour game, failing to grasp the metaphor of "information consumption."

- Solution: The falling news blocks will break into pixel dust before disappearing. A brief introductory message will be added to the start screen.

Risk 2: Conflict between Readability and Gameplay

- Challenge: If the collapse speed is too fast, users won't have time to read the news content in the background; if it's too slow, the sense of urgency will be lost.
- Solution: Introduce a dynamic balancing algorithm. The survival time of the physical rigid bodies will be dynamically calculated based on the length (number of words) of the news content.

Risk 3: Performance Pressure

- Challenge: Frequent DOM creation and destruction can lead to memory leaks or garbage collection lag.
- Solution: Use "Object Pooling." We will reuse DOM elements, only updating their text content and physical coordinates.